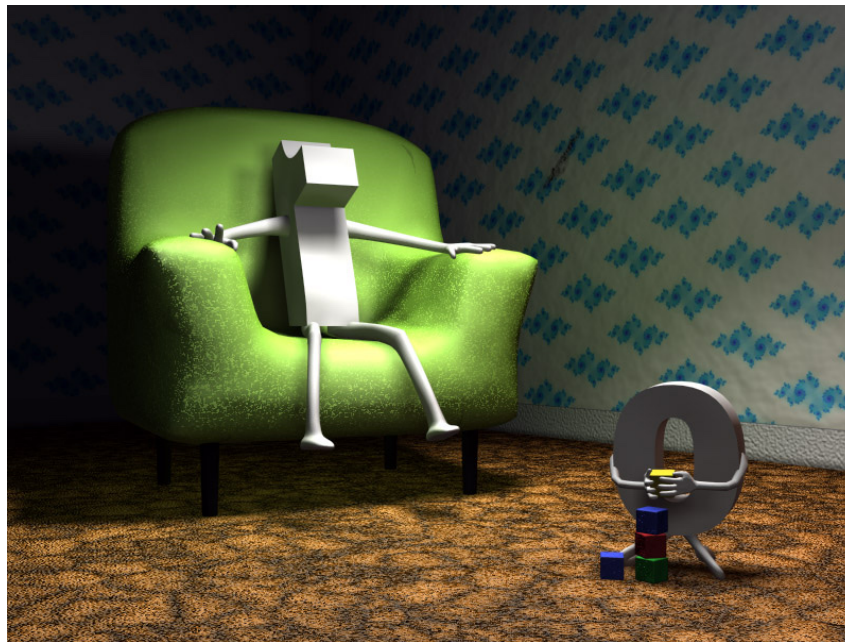


Chapter 1. INTEGERS

1. 2 Divisibility and Prime Factorisation

1.2.2 Gcd. Primes and coprime integers



Today we will prove a very important result:

EUCLID's LEMMA

THEOREM 1.17. Let m and n be relatively prime integers. Then for any integer k

$$(1) \ m|k, \ n|k \Rightarrow mn|k.$$

$$(2) \ m|kn \Rightarrow m|k.$$

Proof. By Bézout's Lemma we have that $1 = xm + yn$, for some integers x and y .

$$(1) \ m|k \Rightarrow k = q_1 m, \text{ for some } q_1 \in \mathbb{Z}$$

$$n|k \Rightarrow k = q_2 n, \text{ for some } q_2 \in \mathbb{Z}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \underline{k} &= 1 \cdot k = (xm + yn)k = (xm)\underline{k} + (yn)k = \\ &= (xm)(q_2 n) + (yn)(q_1 m) = (xq_2 + yq_1)\underline{mn} \end{aligned}$$

$$\Rightarrow \underline{mn|k}$$

$$(2) \ m|kn \Rightarrow kn = qm \text{ for some integer } q.$$

$$\begin{aligned} \underline{k} &= 1 \cdot k = (xm + yn)k = (xk)m + y(nk) \\ &= (xk)m + y(qm) = \underline{(xk + yq)m} \end{aligned}$$

$$\Rightarrow m \mid K \quad \blacksquare$$

Know fact $\left. \begin{array}{l} m, n \text{ integers} \\ mn \text{ even} \end{array} \right\} \Rightarrow \begin{array}{l} m \text{ is even} \\ \text{or} \\ n \text{ is even} \end{array}$

$$2 \mid mn \Rightarrow 2 \mid m \text{ or } 2 \mid n$$

EUCLID'S LEMMA. Let p be a prime.

- (1) If $p \mid mn$ where m and n are integers, then either $p \mid m$ or $p \mid n$.
- (2) If $p \mid m_1 m_2 \dots m_r$ where each m_i is an integer, then $p \mid m_i$ for some i .

Proof. Let $d = \gcd(m, p)$. Then by definition $d \geq 1$ and $d \mid p$. From here since p is prime, we have that either $d = 1$ or $d = p$.

If $d = p$, then $p \mid m$ and we are done. Otherwise, if $d = 1$ then m and p are coprime.

$$\left. \begin{array}{l} p \mid mn \\ p, m \text{ are coprime} \end{array} \right\} \xRightarrow{\text{thm 1.17(2)}} p \mid n$$

Remark. Euclid's Lemma might not be true if p is NOT a prime.

$$6 \mid 3 \cdot 4 \quad \text{and} \quad 6 \nmid 3 \quad \text{and} \quad 6 \nmid 4.$$